

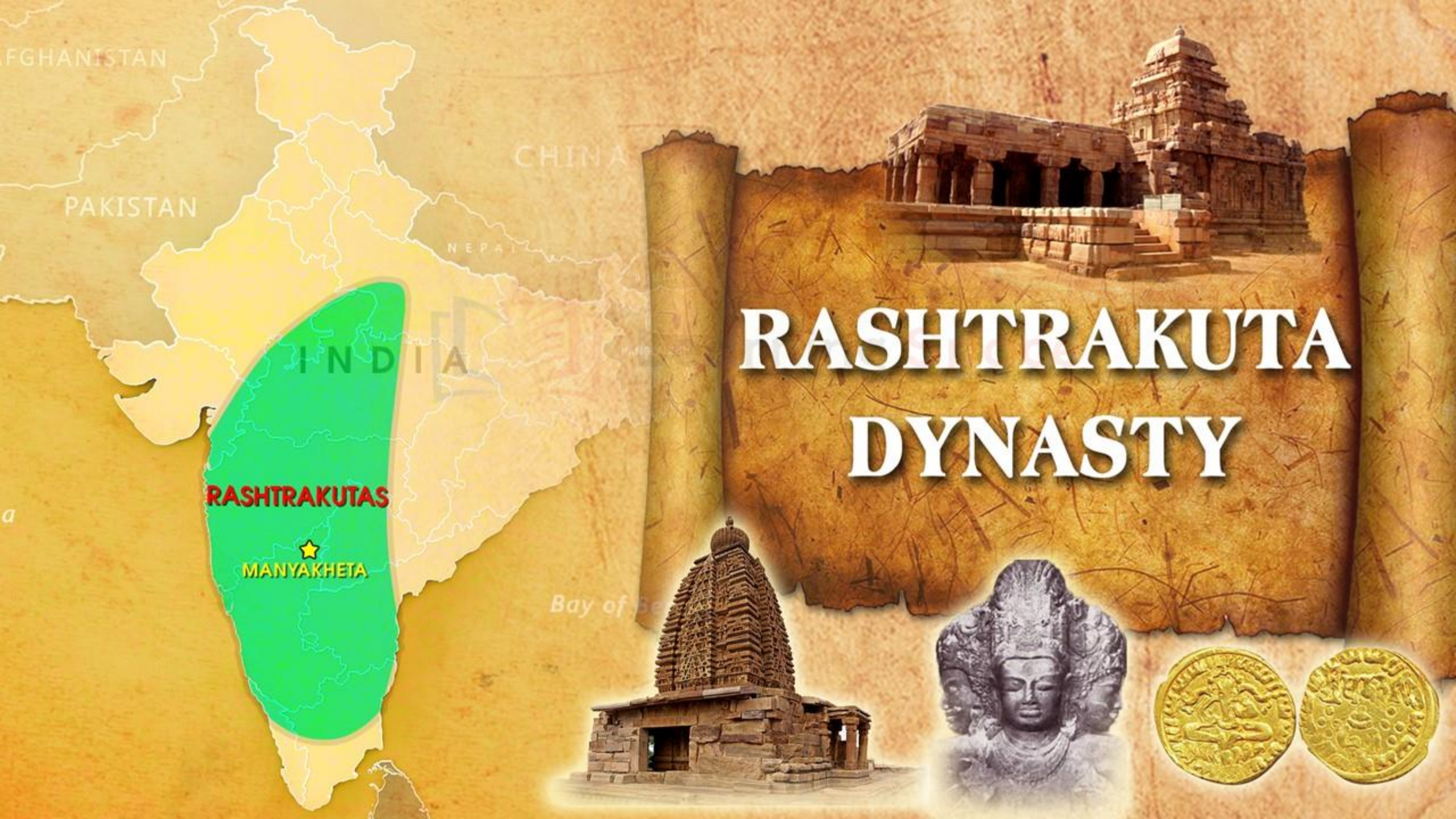
MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 4

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

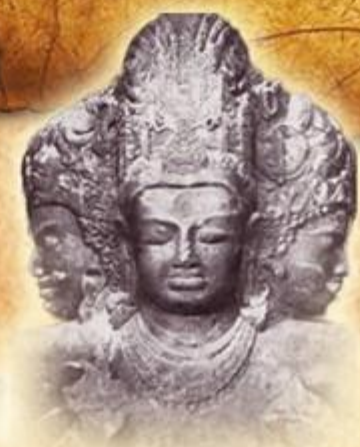




RASHTRAKUTAS

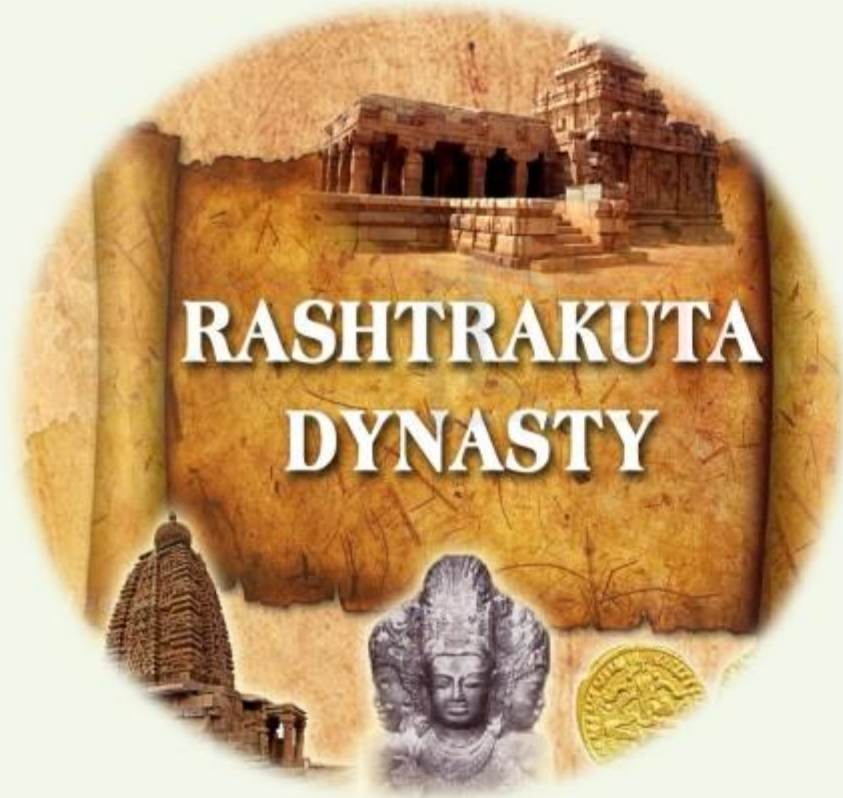
MANYAKHETA

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

INTRODUCTION



- 1 “RASHTRAKUTA” - means the chief of ‘*Rashtra*’

- 2 They are presumed to be a feudatory of the Chalukyas, and their capital was **MANYAKHETA** or **MALKHED** near Sholapur.
- 3 Historians also link The Rashtrakutas from **Kannada origin** as *Kannada language* was their mother tongue.
- 4 They ***achieved spectacular military success*** in the TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE and they mostly defeated the Palas and the Pratiharas
- 5 Their victories in the tripartite struggle brought ***rich plunder*** and added to the might of the Rashtrakuta Empire.



IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

NEPAL

BHUTAN

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

OMAN

Arabian Sea

RASHTRAKUTAS



MANYAKHETA

Bay of Bengal

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

DANTIDURGA [733AD-756 AD]

- 1 Founded the Rashtrakuta Kingdom in 733 AD.
- 2 Was initially a feudatory of the Chalukya King *Kirtivarman II*. He took control over the northern region of Chalukya empire to ascend to throne.
- 3 He defeated the *Gurjaras* and captured *Malwa* from them.
- 4 *Dantidurga* (name) signifies his military feats and accomplishments.
- 5 Dantidurga ruled from **ACHALAPURA** in Berar (modern day ELLICHPUR in Maharashtra).

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]

↓
KRISHNA - I
[756 AD-774 AD]

↓
DHURVA
[780 AD-793 AD]

↓
GOVIND III
[793AD-814 AD]

↓
AMOGHA VASRSHA- I
[814 AD-878 AD]

↓
INDRA - III
[914AD - 929AD]

↓
KRISHNA - III
[939AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

KRISHNA - I

[756AD-774 AD]



- 1 Dantidurga's successor Krishna-I was also a great conqueror.
- 2 He extended the Rashtrakuta Empire and brought major portions of:
 - ✓ Present day Karnataka
 - ✓ Konkan Under his control
- 3 He defeated the Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi.
- 4 Rock cut **KAILASHNATH TEMPLE** was built at **ELLORA** during his reign.

KAILASHNATH TEMPLE

Monolithic

Dedicated to Lord Shiva

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]

KRISHNA - I
[756 AD-774 AD]

DHRUVA
[780 AD-793 AD]

GOVIND III
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[814 AD-878 AD]

INDRA - III
[914AD - 929AD]

KRISHNA - III
[936AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

ROCK CUT KAILASHNATH TEMPLE AT ELLORA



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

DHRUVA [780AD-793 AD]

- 1 Rashtrakuta became a pan Indian power during his reign.
- 2 His reign saw:
 - Expansion of kingdom that now encompassed all the territory between
 - ✓ Kaveri River and
 - ✓ Central India
- 3 Successful expeditions to KANNAUJ, where he defeated the
 - ✓ Gurjara-Pratihara (Nagabhata II) and
 - ✓ the Palas of Bengal (Dharampala)

B.—Naregal Inscription of Dhruva.



DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]



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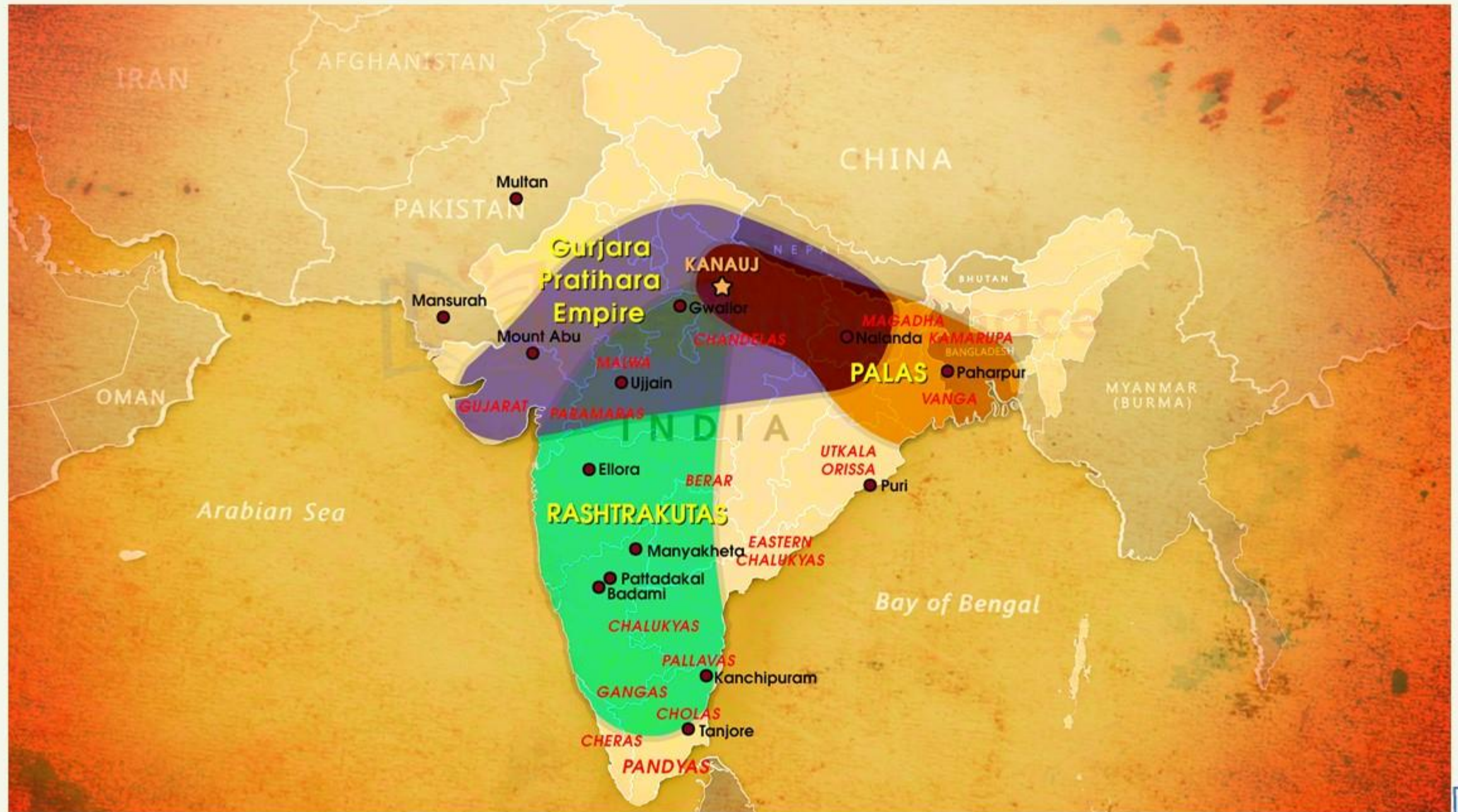


INDRA - III
[914AD - 929AD]



KRISHNA - III
[936AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

GOVIND - III [793AD-814 AD]

- 1 Son of Dhruva. He carried the legacy of Rashtrakuta empire to greater heights.
- 2 He too dominated in the tripartite struggle as he:
 - ✓ Defeated the **Pala King Dharmapala**
 - ✓ Defeated the Pratihara King **Nagabhatta II at Malwa**
- 3 His military exploits has been compared to **Alexander the Great** and **Arjuna of Mahabharatha** in inscriptions of the period.
- 4 After victory in **Kannauj** and conquering Gujarat and Kosala, he moved towards South and dominated the **Pallavas of Kanchi** and installed the ruler of his choice in **Vengi**.
- 5 Govind III received
 - 2 statues from King of Ceylon as an act of submission
 - Tributes from
 - ✓ The Cholas
 - ✓ The Pandyas
 - ✓ The Cheras

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]



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[936AD - 967AD]



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

AMOGHA VASRSHA-I [814 AD-878 AD]



1

AMOGHA VASRSHA I was one of the greatest rulers of the Rashtrakuta tradition. His rule of 64 years is one of the longest dated monarchical rule on record.

2

Amoghavarsha

- He built the new capital city for the Kingdom in MANYAKHETA (Modern Malkhed).
- He assumed the title of **VIRA-NARAYANA** after defeating the invading 'Eastern Chalukya' at Vingavalli.
- He, unlike his father, preferred to maintain friendly relation with his neighbours like Eastern Chalukyas and the Pallavas.
- He also cultivated marital ties with them to strengthen the bond.

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]



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AMOGHA VASRSHA-I [814 AD-878 AD]



3

Amogha Vasrsha - I

- A patron of literature
- Was an accomplished scholar in Kannada and Sanskrit.

4

Wrote

- *Kavi Raja Marga* (Earliest Kannada work on poetry).
- *Prashanottara Ratna Malika* in Sanskrit.

5

Because of his religious temperament, his interest in the arts and literature and his peace-loving nature, he is often compared to emperor Ashoka and called "*Ashoka of the South*"

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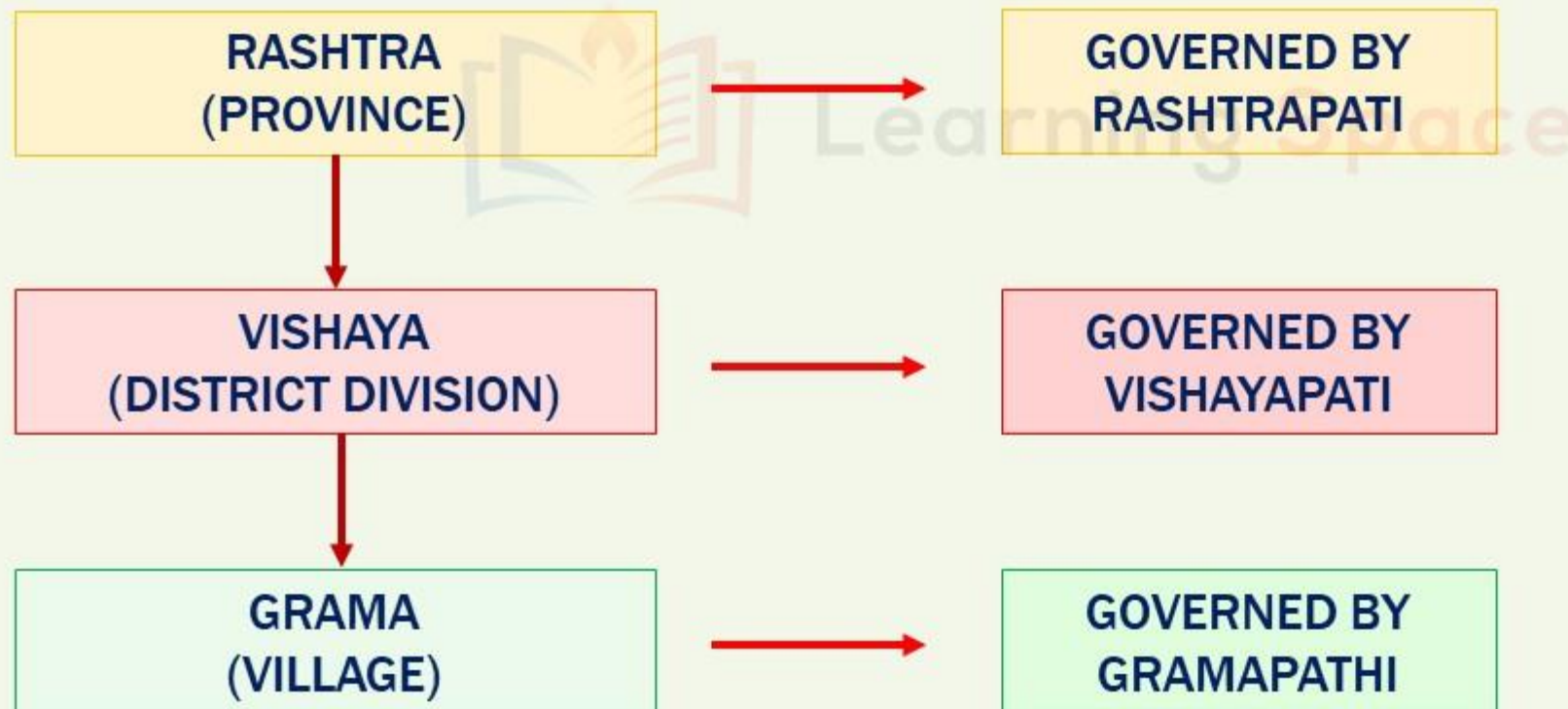


KRISHNA - III
[936AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

AMOGHA VASRSHA-I [814 AD-878 AD]

6 Amogha Varsha's kingdom comprised of 16 Rashtra (provinces)



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INDRA - III
[914AD - 929AD]



KRISHNA - III
[936AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

INDRA - III [914AD-929 AD]



- 1 Grandson of Amogh Varsha - I
- 2 He was a great warrior and capable ruler of the Rashtrakuta Dynasty
- 3 He was a wise manager and adroit military campaigner.
- 4 He crushed different rebellions and re-established the empire
- 5 He defeated Pratihara's King Mahipal I in 915 CE and emerged as the most powerful ruler of his times.

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]



KRISHNA - I
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INDRA - III
[914AD - 929AD]



KRISHNA - III
[936AD - 967AD]

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

KRISHNA-III [936AD-967 AD]



- 1 Last great Rashtrakuta ruler
- 2 His territory also included TONDAI-MANDALAM which was the Northern Tamil country.
- 3 He also received tribute from King of Ceylon
- 4 In 949 CE, he defeated the Chola King PARANTAKA I and annexed the northern part of the Chola Empire.
- 5 He had marched towards Rameshwara to set up a **pillar of victory** and then also built a temple.

DANTIDURGA
[733 AD-756 AD]



KRISHNA - I
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RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

AFTER KRISHNA- III



1 After the death of Krishna III, all his opponents united against his successor and in 972 CE defeated him.

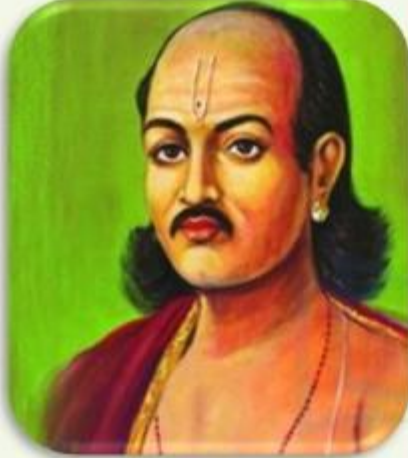
2 They destroyed the capital Malkhed and burnt it to ashes.

This marked the end of Rashtrakutas.



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

POINTS TO REMEMBER



- 1** Rashtrakutas were tolerant towards Islam as they not only allowed Muslim traders to settle here, but also to let them propagate Islam.
- 2** Apabhramsha (language) poet Swayambhu lived at Rashtrakuta court.
- 3** The Rashtrakuta empire controlled most of the western sea coast of the subcontinent which also facilitated its maritime trade.
- 4** Port of BHARUCH was considered as one of the most prominent ports in the world at that time.
- 5** Artists and craftsman functioned as corporations (guilds) rather than as individual businesses.

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

POINTS TO REMEMBER



6 KANNADA – was the court language of Rashtrakutas. ADIKAVI PAMPA – one of the greatest Kannada writers served in Rashtrakuta's court

7 Finest examples of the art and architecture of the Rashtrakutas are found at

- ELLORA – KAILASH TEMPLE
- ELEPHANTA ISLANDS - Images of Shiva carved out in various forms

8 Arab Scholar SULAIMAN ranked Rashtrakuta among the 4 great contemporary empires of the world.

9 According to AL MASUDI in 10th century, most of the kings paid tribute to Rashtrakuta Kings

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

ADMINISTRATION UNDER RASHTRAKUTA



1 The Rashtrakuta Empire was divided into several provinces called Rashtras under the control of Rashtrapatis.

2 Rashtras were further divided into Vishayas or districts governed by Vishayapatis.

3 The next subdivision was

- Bhukti consisting of 50 to 70 villages under the control of Bhogapatis.
- Bhogapatis were directly appointed by the central government.

4 The village administration was carried on by the **village headmen**. However, the village assemblies played a significant role in the village administration.



RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

SOCIETY & ECONOMY



- 1 The Hindu sects of Vaishnavism and Shaivism flourished during the period of Rashtrakutas.
- 2 Yet, they did not affect the progress of Jainism under the patronage of Rashtrakuta kings.

- 3 Almost **one third of the population of the Deccan were Jains**. There was harmony among various religions.
- 4 There were some prosperous Buddhist settlements at places like Kanheri, Sholapur and Dharwar.
- 5 There was a college at Salatogi, situated in modern Bijapur district. It was run by the income from endowments made by the rich as well as by all the villagers on occasions of functions and festivals.
- 6 The economy was also in a flourishing condition. There was an active commerce between the Deccan and the Arabs. The Rashtrakuta kings promoted the Arab trade by maintaining friendship with them.

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

ART & ARCHITECTURE

The art and architecture of the Rashtrakutas is found at Ellora and Elephanta.



ELLORA

- At Ellora, the most remarkable temple is the Kailasa temple.
- It was excavated during the reign of Krishna 1.
- It is carved out of a massive block of rock 200 feet long, and 100 feet in breadth and height.
- The temple consists of four parts —
 - ✓ the main shrine,
 - ✓ the entrance gateway,
 - ✓ an intermediate shrine for Nandi and
 - ✓ mandap surrounding the courtyard.

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

ART & ARCHITECTURE



ELLORA

- The Kailasa temple is an architectural marvel with its beautiful sculptures.
- The sculpture of the Goddess Durga is shown as slaying the Buffalo demon.
- In another sculpture, Ravana was making attempts to lift Mount Kailasa, the abode of Siva.
- The scenes of Ramayana were also depicted on the walls.
- The general characteristics of the Kailasa temple are more Dravidian.

RASHTRAKUTA DYNASTY

ART & ARCHITECTURE

ELEPHANTA



- Elephanta is an island near Mumbai and was originally called Sripuri.
- The Portuguese after seeing the large figure of an elephant named it Elephanta.
- There is a close similarity between the sculptures at Ellora and those in Elephanta.
- At the entrance to the sanctum there are huge figures of **Dwara-palakas**.
- In the walls of the prakara around the sanctum there are niches containing the images of Shiva in various forms
 - ✓ Nataraja
 - ✓ Gangadhara
 - ✓ Ardha-naree-swara and
 - ✓ Somaskanda.

- The most imposing figure of this temple is **TRIMURTHI**. The sculpture is 6 metre high which represent the three aspects of Shiva as Creator, Preserver and Destroyer.

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